

Testing times: India beat lower-ranked Wales and Pakistan but lost all three of its matches against higher-ranked opponents — England, Netherlands and Argentina — going down 5-3 to the South American side.

AFP

this year. Head coach Craig Fulton shouldered responsibility for the loss, but the repeated errors and indecision on the field must be shared by the players, too.

India came into the tournament as the World No. 8 side. It also played like one and will likely finish in the same position. There aren't any players who will come out of this World Cup with their reputations enhanced.

It was a collective misfiring from every department in this debacle. If not for Harmanpreet Singh's dragflicks, which yielded six goals, this could have ended even worse.

This side expectedly beat lower-ranked sides Wales and Pakistan, but lost all three of its outings against teams ranked above it — England, Netherlands and Argentina.

The only consistent thing about this team has been how consistently it has played well in just two of the four quarters in these matches.

The losses against these three nations highlighted how far behind India is when it comes to speed, physicality and technical ability. The ease with which some of the Argentine players beat their markers with skill and directness was in stark contrast to India, which



Underwhelming run: India arrived at the World Cup ranked eighth in the world but delivered a collective failure across departments. Harmanpreet Singh's dragflicks, which produced six goals, were one of the few bright spots. But repeated injury concerns for the captain, who played the second-round matches with a back strain, will add to coach Craig Fulton's woes. GETTYIMAGES

struggled to break open opposition defences.

Fulton conceded that his players were struggling to form the connections needed to get into good scoring positions inside the circle. Among the top eight sides, India had scored the fewest field goals after five games.

With only the 7th-8th classification game left [at the time

« The performances of some of the seniors, including Amit Rohidas and Mandeep Singh (right), were less than desirable. »

